EXCERPT | PARENT ROUNDTABLE SERIES

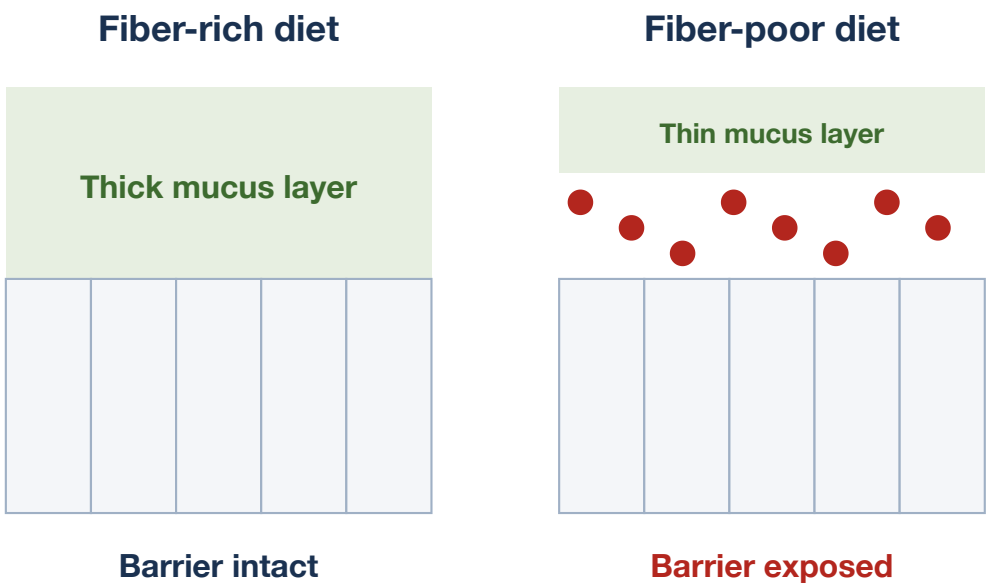
The Science Behind Inflammatory Foods

How gut inflammation becomes whole-body inflammation, and the everyday food choices that shift it

Deborah M. Burke-Allen, RPh
Registered Pharmacist | Parent education roundtable



Feed the gut, or it will feed on you

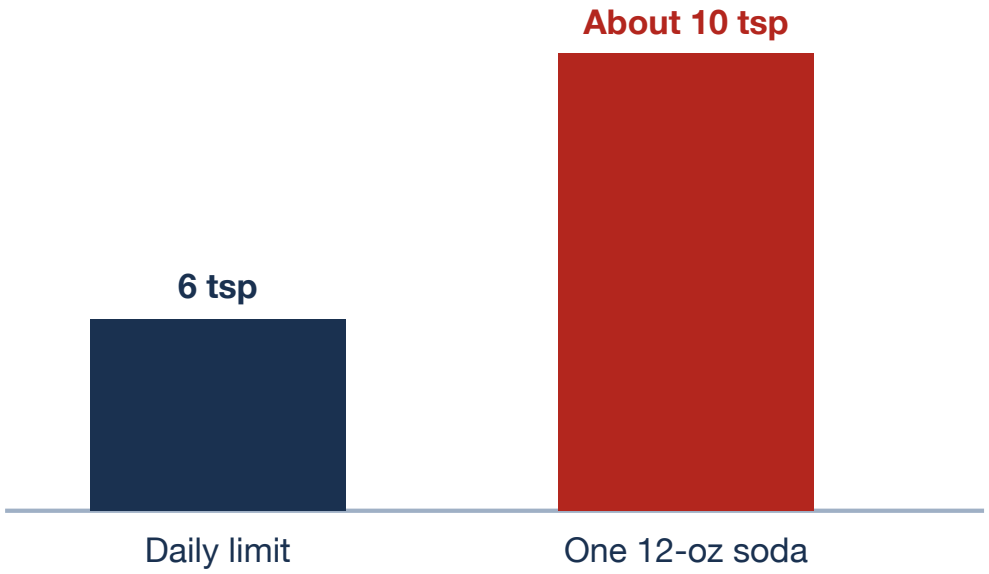


- Fiber feeds the gut microbes that help keep the protective mucus layer thick
- In a mouse study, microbes starved of fiber began breaking down that mucus layer instead
- Vegetables, fruits, beans, and whole grains keep the barrier fed

Desai MS, et al. Cell. 2016;167(5):1339-53. PMID 27863247 (animal study)

ADDED SUGAR

Children should have less than 6 teaspoons of added sugar a day



- The American Heart Association advises under 25 grams (about 6 teaspoons) of added sugar a day for ages 2 to 18
- No added sugar before age 2
- No more than one 8-ounce sugary drink a week

Vos MB, et al. Circulation. 2017;135(19):e1017-34. PMID 27550974

THE HEALTHY PLATE

A better plate lowered heart disease risk by up to 39%

- Adults who ate closest to the Harvard-style healthy eating pattern had 39% lower cardiovascular disease risk in men and 28% lower in women

> Major chronic disease risk was 20% lower in men and 11% lower in women.

What the plate looks like

- Water instead of sugary drinks
- More vegetables than fruit; potatoes do not count
- Whole grains over refined grains
- Fish, poultry, beans, and nuts
- Olive oil; avoid trans fats

McCullough ML, et al. Am J Clin Nutr. 2002;76(6):1261-71. PMID 12450892

WANT THE FULL DECK?

This is an excerpt from a full parent-education roundtable

- Designed, researched, and presented by a registered pharmacist
- Every clinical claim cited and verified in PubMed
- Written for parents; reviewed to a professional medical-content standard

See the full deck and more

deborahburkeallen.github.io/recruiters.html

bridgestowellness@icloud.com